XJTLU Entrepreneur College (Taicang)
Entrepreneurship & Enterprise Hub

ENT207TC
Digital Startup Lab
GROUP ASSESSMENT BRIEF

Semester 1 | Academic Year 2026-2027
Module Leaders: Dr. Bogdan Marculescu & Dr. Stefan Seedorf

Module Title	Digital Startup Lab
Module Code	ENT207TC
Module Credits	5
Module Leaders	Dr. Bogdan Marculescu & Dr. Stefan Seedorf
Assessment Type	Group Coursework (100%)
Submission Deadlines	Component 1 (Weekly Process): Ongoing — final upload before end of Week 10 Component 2 (Final Deliverables): Draft 1 — Week 4; Draft 2 — Week 9; compiled package before end of Week 10 Component 3 (Demo Day): Week 10 (date TBC) Component 4 (Journey Reflection): Before end of Week 10
Method of Submission	Demo Day (live) + Electronic via LMO / Turnitin
Late Submission Policy	5% deduction per day (up to 5 days). Beyond 5 days = non-submission.
Learning Outcomes Tested	A, B, C, D, E (see Module Handbook for full descriptions)

1. ASSESSMENT STRUCTURE

Grade Composition

The group grade is composed of four components, in line with the ENT207TC Module Handbook:

Component	Weight	Type	Description
Component 1: Weekly Process	40%	Group	Weekly milestone deliverables, Kanban maintenance, documented progress.
Component 2: Final Deliverables	30%	Group	Drafts + Checkpoints + Digital Prototype Report + Promotion Report + User Testing Report.
Component 3: Demo Day	20%	Group	Live Demo Day performance + professionally produced video with subtitles.
Component 4: Journey Reflection	10%	Group	End-of-semester reflective report on process, support, tools, and recommendations.
TOTAL	**100%**		

Individual Marks

All members of a group ordinarily receive the same mark, based on the group grade above. There is no peer-review formula this year. Where accumulated process evidence such as Kanban history, weekly milestone submissions, TA check-in notes, and Mentor observations clearly show that a student's contribution was substantially different from their teammates', Module Leaders and EEH Mentors may adjust that student's individual mark relative to the group mark. Any such adjustment is capped at a maximum of 10 percentage points, and is decided by Module Leaders and/or EEH Mentors based on process evidence, as per Section 14 of the Module Handbook ("Final Review").

Students are strongly encouraged to keep their own evidence of contribution (Kanban activity, communications, milestone submissions) throughout the semester in case questions of individual contribution arise.

2. PROJECT SELECTION & GROUP FORMATION

Finding Your Project

In Weeks 1–2, each group selects a real-world problem to solve with a digital solution that can realistically be built within the semester. While most teams are expected to build apps, other digital solutions are acceptable if they address an industry-relevant challenge and demonstrate technical depth (e.g., intelligent agents, interactive dashboards, AI tools, or advanced web applications). Static or overly simple solutions do not qualify.

Group Formation

Groups are formed with approximately seven members, based on project interest. Project fields may include (but are not limited to): AFCT, AIAC, IME, IOT, IRE, IFB, CHIPS, EEH, and other emerging areas.

Validation Process

1. Brainstorming — generate multiple problem ideas and propose digital solutions.
2. Peer Feedback — present ideas to another group using the Green / Yellow / Red system.
3. Faculty Approval — EEH Mentors or panel review final ideas. Rejected ideas must pivot and resubmit.

GREEN	Clear problem + realistic and buildable solution. Proceeds to development.
YELLOW	Valid problem but solution needs more clarity or scoping. Revise and resubmit.
RED	Problem unclear or solution unrealistic. Full pivot required.

Peer Feedback Form — Problem/Solution Evaluation

Group Giving Feedback:	
Group Receiving Feedback:	
Problem/Solution Being Evaluated:	
Vote (circle one):	GREEN | YELLOW | RED
Reasoning (1–2 sentences):	

3. COMPONENT DETAILS

NOTE: Each team is expected to engage with at least one External Mentor during the semester (XEC faculty, industry practitioner, alumnus, or domain expert). Document this using the External Mentor Feedback Form (Form 3 of the Module Handbook) by end of Week 9 — at least one submission per semester is required. This is scored once (not weekly) under the "External Mentor" criterion in the Weekly Process rubric below.

NOTE: "Features" referenced throughout this brief (e.g., "three core features") should follow the guidance in Appendix A: Acceptable Features for Projects. Login-only functionality, static/landing pages, generic contact forms, and visual polish without underlying logic do not count as features.

Component 1 (40%): Weekly Process

The project is completed through weekly milestones. Each week builds toward the group's overall deliverables, with documented evidence of progress. Teams should maintain an active Kanban board throughout the semester — this is verified as evidence of how the team organises and executes work.

To establish a transparent individual contribution trail, students are strongly encouraged to use the module's digital workspace portal, where card movements and digital proofs are aggregated automatically. Students choosing the manual route must carefully document their own weekly individual contributions. Each week's Form 1 log also includes a short individual reflection field for every team member.

Weekly Process Rubric

Criteria	4 – Excellent	3 – Good	2 – Satisfactory	1 – Needs Improvement	0 – Unacceptable	Weight
Progress	Significant progress, new features built, clear learning	Good progress, meaningful work done	Some progress; partial completion	Minimal progress, surface-level work	No visible progress	Equal
Evidence	Rich, authentic evidence and user engagement	Clear evidence with real validation	Basic or internal-only validation	Weak or generic with limited validation	No real evidence	Equal
Clarity	Polished, coherent, and clear submission	Generally clear and logically presented	Average clarity, some gaps	Unclear thinking or confusing delivery	Very poor clarity	Equal
Team & Resilience	Highly reliable, communicates openly, supports teammates, shows resilience	Generally reliable, communicates well	Meets basics, inconsistent follow-through	Often late or non-responsive	Disruptive or avoids tasks	Equal
External Mentor*	Engagement evidenced early, clearly documented, and integrated into work	Engagement evidenced and referenced, partly used	Engagement evidenced but only shortly before the Week 9 deadline, limited integration	Weak or indirect evidence of engagement by Week 9	No mentor interaction evidenced by Week 9	Equal

Total possible: 20 points per week (5 criteria x 4 = 20).

**Unlike the other four criteria, External Mentor is assessed cumulatively across the semester, not scored fresh each week — the requirement is one documented engagement (Form 3) by end of Week 9.*

Component 2 (30%): Final Deliverables

The Final Deliverables are a curated record of your team's project journey from idea to launch-ready product: three Checkpoint Reports plus three standalone reports (Digital Prototype, Promotion, User Testing), submitted at the end of the semester.

Draft Submissions

Two formal drafts of the Final Deliverables must be submitted via the milestone platform (or sent directly to your assigned Mentor):

- Draft 1 (Week 4): digital prototype report — the problem, solution concept, and chosen features.
- Draft 2 (Week 9): tech stack choice, promotion report, and user testing report.

Submitting these drafts on time matters — they form the evidence trail that supports your team's final grade.

Final Deliverables Contents

Document	Due	Contents
Checkpoint 1 Report	End of Week 3	Problem choice and validation evidence, solution concept, digital prototype (chosen features).
Checkpoint 2 Report	End of Week 7	Tech stack rationale, working app with 3 features, Kanban evidence, building reflection.
Checkpoint 3 Report	End of Week 9	Promotion evidence (channels, reach, engagement), user testing data (10+ testers), bug fixes implemented, launch readiness self-assessment.

Document	Due	Contents
Digital Prototype Report	End of Week 10	Final product documentation: architecture overview, feature set, tech stack, access instructions for assessors, known limitations.
Promotion Report	End of Week 10	Channels used (with dates), materials deployed (video link, landing page), reach and engagement metrics, testers onboarded, what worked / what did not, timestamped evidence screenshots.
User Testing Report	End of Week 10	Structured report on 10+ real users: testing methodology, key findings, user quotes or data, changes implemented based on feedback.

Final Deliverables Rubric

Excellent (27–30)	Good (21–26)	Satisfactory (15–20)	Needs Improvement (9–14)	Weak (0–8)
All six documents present, comprehensive, well-written, with rich evidence at each checkpoint. Demonstrates clear learning progression.	All documents present, good depth, evidence is clear and consistent.	Most documents present; some lack depth or evidence quality.	Incomplete Final Deliverables or major gaps in evidence.	Final Deliverables largely missing or do not reflect actual project journey.

Component 3 (20%): Demo Day

Demo Day is the culmination of your startup journey. Each team delivers a live presentation and Q&A, showcasing their working application to an audience of peers, mentors, and invited guests.

Demo Day Deliverables

- Live demonstration of the app with real functionality.
- Presentation slides (PPTX or PDF) — clear, narrative-driven, audience-ready.
- App access for assessors (published link / test account / APK / repository with README).
- Demo Day Live Recording — the official recording captured during the event (the team is responsible to record). Submitted with your Component 3 package.
- Professional Video Submission — a separately produced video by your team, edited with subtitles, professional quality, representing your best public-facing pitch. Upload as MP4.

Minimum Requirements for Digital Solutions

To qualify for Demo Day, each team's solution must include:

- A user-facing interface (app, dashboard, or web tool).
- User input and interaction (form, voice, chat, or data upload).
- At least five screens with logical, structured navigation.
- User authentication (login functionality).
- Three core features or functions (see Appendix A for what counts as a feature).
- Support for real user testing (minimum 10 users).
- A clearly defined use case and demonstrable technical value.
- Your demonstration of your working digital prototype must satisfy the interactive simulation requirement. As part of the live demonstration, walk through a realistic user scenario simulation within your app — the inputs, the interaction, the resulting output — and explain how that insight would inform a real product, market, or operational decision for your venture.

Demo Day Rubric

#	Criteria	Excellent (12–15)	Good (9–11)	Satisfactory (6–8)	Needs Improvement (3–5)	Weak (0–2)
1	App Concept & Problem Fit	Clearly defined, future-relevant problem; innovative and feasible solution.	Clear problem and realistic solution; moderate innovation.	Problem and solution somewhat aligned; idea is generic.	Problem unclear or poorly defined.	Weak or copycat solution.
2	Functionality & Problem-Solving	Strong functionality; features well integrated; clear system flow and data use; real-world applicability.	Functional; most features work; evidence of user feedback or iteration.	Technically functional but limited; some parts basic or surface-level.	Limited functionality or broken elements; problem-solving vague.	Not functional or fails to show meaningful problem-solving.
3	User Engagement & Delivery	10+ real users; clear iteration; polished pitch; confident delivery; professional video with subtitles. Handles live issues calmly.	5–10 users; visible changes from feedback; well-structured presentation. Promo pack complete.	Fewer than 5 users; some cosmetic changes; presentation okay but lacks polish.	Minimal user feedback; iteration unclear; presentation incomplete. Struggled under pressure.	No evidence of users, changes, or planning. Video missing or unwatchable.
4	Navigating Organisational Complexities	Anticipates barriers; strategic communication; shows initiative and diplomacy.	Understands structures; adjusts approach; handles setbacks constructively.	Recognises basic processes but struggles with adapting strategy.	Limited awareness of organisational systems or stakeholder roles.	Fails to adapt to challenges; misunderstandings or missed opportunities.

Component 4 (10%): Journey Reflection

We want honest, specific reflection about the format, support received, tools used, and the learning experience — plus ideas for improvement. Minimum 900 meaningful words total. One upload per group at the end of the semester. No references required. This reflection should draw on and build from each member's individual weekly reflections submitted through the semester.

Please address the following prompts (2–4 sentences each):

- Format & flow: What worked or did not in the startup studio model?
- EEH support: What support from EEH (Mentors, workspace, feedback) helped? What was missing?
- School support: What support from your home school helped? What was missing?
- Mentor support: One concrete example where your EEH Mentor materially helped — or could have.
- TA support: Was the TA check-in process useful? What would have improved it?
- AI Agents: Did you use AI agents in your product or workflow? What value did they add, or not?
- Kanban: Did the Kanban board help your team's organization? What would you change?
- Learning environment: Did sessions feel safe, inclusive, and collaborative? One enabler and one blocker.
- Barriers & enablers: Top two blockers and how you got past them; top two supports that mattered.
- Two low-effort fixes we can implement for future students.

Journey Reflection Rubric

Excellent (17–20)	Good (13–16)	Satisfactory (9–12)	Needs Improvement (5–8)	Weak (0–4)
Insightful, specific, and deeply reflective with clear writing.	Good awareness and detail, coherent reflection.	General summary with limited insight.	Surface-level, vague, or messy.	No meaningful reflection or very unclear writing.

4. SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

What to Upload and How

Component	Upload Instructions
Component 1: Weekly Process	Submit weekly via the milestone tracking platform. Final consolidated upload (all weeks) due by end of Week 10.
Component 2: Final Deliverables	Draft 1 (Week 4) and Draft 2 (Week 9) submitted via the milestone platform or to your Mentor. One ZIP containing all six Final Deliverables documents (3 Checkpoint Reports + Digital Prototype Report + Promotion Report + User Testing Report) in PDF or DOCX; Checkpoint Reports may be submitted incrementally at each checkpoint. Final compiled package due end of Week 10.
Component 3: Demo Day	One ZIP containing: (1) Presentation slides, (2) App access instructions, (3) Live recording of Demo Day (provided by module team), (4) Professional video (MP4 with subtitles). Upload by Demo Day deadline.
Component 4: Journey Reflection	Single PDF/DOCX (900+ words). Upload by end of Week 10.

File naming convention: GroupNumber_ComponentX_ComponentName_Date (e.g., Group5_Component2_Checkpoint2_2026.pdf)

All uploads go through the designated assignment submission link on Learning Mall Online. Verify that your upload is successful and that files are viewable. Late or inaccessible files are treated as non-submission.

Only the group leader uploads the files. All group members are responsible for ensuring the upload is complete.

Referencing

Use APA referencing where applicable. Include in-text citations and a reference list at the end of any report that draws on external sources. No reference list is required for the Journey Reflection. For APA guidance: https://libguides.lib.xjtlu.edu.cn/xjtlureferencing

5. PERFORMANCE DESCRIPTORS

Grade	Points	Class	Descriptors
A	81+	First	Outstanding work at the upper limit of performance. Mastery of advanced techniques beyond what was taught. Synthesis of ideas from across the subject. Evidence of outstanding individual contribution in group work.
B	70–80	First	Excellent range and depth. Mastery of a wide range of methods. Evidence of study and originality beyond what was taught. Excellent individual contribution.
C	60–69	Upper Second	All learning outcomes attained. Good use of methods. Evidence of comprehension and synthesis beyond taught content. Productive individual contribution.
D	50–59	Lower Second	Some limitations but most objectives met. Evidence of study. Adequate presentation. Positive individual contribution.

Grade	Points	Class	Descriptors
E	40–49	Third	Limited attainment of outcomes. Basic methods demonstrated. Insecure grasp of content. Poorly presented.
F	0–39	Fail	Minority of outcomes attained. Weak and incomplete grasp of content. Incoherent presentation.
G	0	Fail	No significant assessable material, absent, or missing a must-pass component.

APPENDIX A: ACCEPTABLE FEATURES FOR PROJECTS

The list below illustrates types of features that are acceptable and meaningful in ENT207TC (Module Handbook, Section 21). These are here to inspire, not to restrict. What matters is that every feature directly helps solve a real problem for your intended users. You are not building for practice — you are building to make a difference.

Navigation & Access

- Guest access with limited functionality
- Role-based access (admin, user, mentor, etc.)
- Structured user flows with access-specific content

User Interaction Features

- Customizable profile that influences app functionality
- Dynamic task or goal tracker with progress logic
- Smart calendar or reminder tied to user input or behavior
- Gamified progress indicators (badges, levels, streaks)

AI & Smart Features

- Chatbot trained on specific user needs or data
- AI-generated suggestions that adapt over time
- AI agents that perform tasks autonomously within your app
- Input analysis with personalized recommendations
- Auto-generated summaries or reflections from user content

Logic, Data & Feedback Systems

- User-facing database features (filter, sort, search)
- Real-time leaderboard or comparison system
- Analytics dashboard that visualizes trends
- Systems that evolve based on cumulative user activity

Advanced Features

- Integrations that add real functionality (AI, finance, weather, IoT)
- Secure and useful use of OpenAI, DeepSeek, Gemini, or similar models
- APIs offering content, evaluation, or communication support
- Webhooks or external automations supporting your use case

Features NOT Counted as Core Features

Feature	Reason
Login system only	Expected infrastructure, not a solution
Static content or landing page	No user input or interactivity
Contact form	Too generic unless purpose-specific
Basic calendar	Must be tied to user logic or insights
Visual polish without logic	Design without behavior does not count